

CMS.100: List of AI use cases developed in class

This is a transcription of the student responses on AI use written on notecards during class on September 11, 2026. The ultimate AI policy for each student is individual under the confines of MIT's "limited use" AI policy. The following responses are not intended as official class rules, but a transcription of our in-class brainstorm. They have been transcribed verbatim but similar responses have been grouped together.

Acceptable	Not acceptable
Fixing grammar errors • Using AI to check grammar • Grammar and spelling checking • Using Grammarly for grammar is not bad, but the help you get is minimal • Proofreading assistance (grammar, structure). Why edge? AI writing slop is very easy to spot and it's bad but as a tool it is useful • Using AI to check grammar and find synonyms • Using AI tools to fix more grammatical / syntax errors • Grammar tools (e.g. Grammarly) • Use for grammar and limiting redundancy	Fixing grammar errors • Asking AI to fix grammar and sentence structure • Grammarly
Brainstorming, testing, or generating ideas • Using AI to challenge thoughts / make us think harder • Using AI to tell us if we're on the right track or not • Brainstorm ideas, test my own ideas • You can share your initial ideas about your paper and its structure • Using AI to test knowledge and stuff	Brainstorming, testing, or generating ideas • Coming up with all of the ideas itself and copying verbatim from the AI → using the way of writing that AI uses • Generating ideas, thesis, and arguments • Forming an opinion • Telling you what you should do • Do your whole work for you • Having AI give us ideas
Research assistance • You can ask AI for suggestions and adjustments along with an explanation why • Explain concepts / ideas to you • Find valid sources, documents, or any other form of information that has been validated by an authority • Searching an unknown word / detail and reading the AI summary • Research and summary guide: useful when skimming but overlooks details	Research assistance • Using LLMs to find sources, quotes, etc – I think there's value in surveying media / literature yourself because it's driven by your individual interests and whatever you look at says something about that • Using AI to gather / aggregate sources for initial research • Using AI tools to learn about our topics / cases without consulting other sources • Trusting AI work without double checking • Sensitive or abstract topics

• Using AI to find resources • Fact checking and the search for supplemental material related to the topic	<i>Summarization</i> • Summarize reading in order to easily pinpoint info / quotes needed for essay • Summarizing full reading • Summarizing texts and taking the ideas • Using AI to summarize reading • Active summary
Review • When you've read your work too many times and you really need a second pair of eyes without immediate access to another person • Brainstorming for ideas • Check your work?? • Give feedback	Review • Using AI to give constructive feedback • Using AI tools to directly edit
Writing • Asking AI for a word or a phrase you cannot recall or synonyms • Having the idea and seeking help in wording it	Writing • Copy and paste a complete version of my original draft and submit the version AI produced • After the first time I asked GPT to straighten it, I just go "ok now make it 500 words" or stop putting my own personal effort in refining it. I think that becomes Chat's words and stops becoming my own • Using AI to singlehandedly rewrite / restructure chunk of assignments when your plan changes • AI slop (generated writing or imagery)
Review • When you've read your work too many times and you really need a second pair of eyes without immediate access to another person • Brainstorming for ideas • Check your work?? • Give feedback	Review • Using AI to give constructive feedback • Using AI tools to directly edit
	Conceptual • Chat GPT (ethical reasons)